

Facebook product manager, Roy Zhang, lists several advantages of the Web based Atom. “While Web apps in general offer several advantages for engineers — for example, automatic backups, remote access and server-side processing, Atom on the desktop still enjoyed several features that were not available in the browser, such as synchronous access to the filesystem, access to local resources, natively implemented dependencies, access to native APIs and unrestricted access to the Internet,” Zhang said.

“During the hackathon, engineers found workarounds to these obstacles and contributed a set of scripts that repackaged Atom’s source so that it runs as a Web app,” he added.

Facebook is not the only tech giant that has worked on the concept of cloud-based development environments for browser access. Google integrated Eclipse Orion within its Google Cloud Shell, while GitLab recently brought out a similar IDE through Koding cloud-based IDE.

Facebook’s Atom in Orbit is certainly an advanced solution over the traditional Atom on the desktop. However, it comes with some challenges in the initial stages. Synchronous access to the filesystem via the `fs` module is not working on the browser version. Additionally, there is no access to native APIs and unrestricted access to the Internet.

You can access the code for Atom in Orbit from a GitHub repository. It also includes the necessary documentation to enable easy customisation of the original tool.

Oculus buys open source supporting, eye-tracking startup, The Eye Tribe

To expand its presence in the world of virtual reality (VR), Facebook-owned Oculus has



acquired The Eye Tribe. The Danish startup is known for its eye-tracking hardware and is equally popular for open source software that has helped many developers build different eye-tracking applications.

Founded back in 2011 by alumni of the IT University of Copenhagen, The Eye Tribe offers eye-tracking technology to

developers. The startup also designs affordable eye trackers that would be the main point of focus for Oculus.

“The Eye Tribe intends to become the leading provider of eye control technology by licensing to vendors in the consumer technology industry,” stated The Eye Tribe on its official website.

The Eye Tribe was initially powering native hardware, but it recently extended its presence and started supporting some ongoing VR developments. At the Mobile World Congress last year, the company showcased its eye-tracking solution on Samsung GearVR. Alongside hardware, The Eye Tribe is enabling eye-tracking among various software solutions. The startup has its open source ITU Gaze Tracker framework that provides eye tracking over off-the-shelf components such as webcams and video cameras. This solution is touted to be the “most popular open source eye-tracking software” for developers.

This acquisition could set the tone for the next level of VR.

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AMD, Mentor Graphics to design Linux based embedded solutions

AMD has decided to expand its strategic partnership with electronics design automation developer Mentor Graphics to reinforce the vision for Linux-based embedded solutions.

As per the terms of the agreement, AMD and Mentor Graphics will enable developers with some customised embedded Linux developments. These will include Mentor Embedded Linux Lite, Sourcery CodeBench Lite and Mentor Embedded Linux.

While the Mentor Embedded Linux Lite allows developers to evaluate and prototype future embedded x86 processors without any charge, the Sourcery CodeBench Lite has the GNU-based C/C++ development and debug tool chain to offer custom Linux target platform development at no cost. There is also Mentor Embedded Linux with commercial terms for project development and Eclipse-based Sourcery CodeBench development environment, data trace analysis and visualisation capabilities.

“AMD’s portfolio of innovative embedded solutions, combined with Mentor’s long-standing leadership in open source software and tools, allows us to broaden our reach while effectively supporting a growing customer base, helping us to achieve continued success,” said Scot Morrison, general manager of the platform business unit, Mentor Graphics Embedded System division. Oregon-based Mentor Graphics originally partnered with AMD back in 2014. That partnership was aimed at providing open source tools for building, debugging, analysing and optimising embedded software.

AMD is dedicatedly working to provide an embedded ecosystem to developers with options to select an ideal platform for specific solutions.